

EnergyLens — Founder Study & Decision Guide

What to learn to turn the platform into a real business — synthesis of our strategy sessions, with current researched figures.

Prepared for Ali Mert Özdemir · 16 June 2026 · Confidence tags: [Certain] verified · [Likely] strong inference · [Estimate] assumption.

TR — Bu doküman tüm konuştuklarımızın özeti + güncel araştırma sayıları. Ana metin İngilizce; her bölümün altında kısa Türkçe özet var. Güven etiketleri: [Certain]=doğrulanmış, [Likely]=güçlü çıkarım, [Estimate]=varsayım.

1. The core truth

The platform is essentially code-complete. The binding constraint to revenue is not more features; it is proof (one real building, one named reference, one real-data case study) and distribution (a repeatable way to reach buyers). [Likely]

Because of this, the first money will not come from cold software subscriptions. The realistic sequence is: non-dilutive grant (EXIST) and/or paid pilot/consulting first, then a reference case study, then thin subscriptions at scale. Selling a SaaS subscription cold to a conservative German buyer with no reference is very hard for a solo founder. [Likely]

TR — Ürün bitti; eksik olan özellik değil, KANIT (gerçek bina + referans + vaka çalışması) ve DAĞITIM. Bu yüzden ilk para soğuk abonelikten değil; önce grant/ücretli pilot/danışmanlık → referans → sonra abonelik. Çekirdek darboğaz founder-execution + pazara çıkış.

2. What the product is and does today

EnergyLens is a Microsoft Fabric + web-app energy-intelligence and decision-support platform. Verified capability surface (from the live codebase): portfolio overview and per-building drill-down; energy/KPI monitoring (EUI, consumption, cost, CO2); anomaly alerts; recommendation engine + action tracking; a compliance hub (EPBD/MEPS radar, CRREM stranding, ESRS-E1, EU Taxonomy); decarbonisation / marginal abatement cost (MACC) curve; financing (BAFA/KfW subsidy capture); solar and battery analysis; an AI copilot; device/IoT connections; a full residential vertical (per-unit KPIs, UVI, resident view, manager dashboard); and a partner/white-label layer for consultants. [Certain]

Honest reality gap: the platform currently runs largely on synthetic data. There is no live pilot, no real-building dataset, and no named reference yet. Closing that gap is the single highest-value next step. [Certain]

TR — Ürün geniş ve gerçekten çalışıyor: portföy, KPI, alarm, öneri, uyum merkezi, MACC, finansman (BAFA/KfW), solar/batarya, copilot, IoT, residential dikey, partner/beyaz-etiket. AMA şu an çoğunlukla sentetik veriyile; pilot/gerçek-veri/referans YOK. En değerli sıradaki iş bu boşluğu kapatmak.

3. Market and competitive landscape

The underlying problem is large and regulation-driven: EU minimum energy performance standards tighten through 2033, and EU building retrofit investment is estimated at up to EUR 175 bn per year. But the software layer is crowded and well-funded, and almost everyone fishes the institutional top of the market. [Certain]

Player	What they are	Funding / scale	Relevance to you
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Deepki (FR)	Enterprise ESG data platform	EUR 150M raised; >500 customers; ~EUR 4 trillion AUM; 80 countries	Top of market (funds, insurers). Not your fight.
Predium (DE)	All-in-one real-estate ESG (CRREM partner)	~EUR 19M (1.6+4.5+13M); Munich	Near-identical product, funded + CRREM-licensed. Avoid head-to-head.
Alasco (DE)	ESG + financial management	Funded	Overlaps your MACC/financing angle.
aedifion (DE)	Building optimisation / operations	~EUR 17-20M Series B	Deep/real-time building ops.
Measurabl (US)	Real-estate sustainability data	Large	Global enterprise.
Reneo (DE)	Residential decarbonisation	Funded	Direct to your residential vertical.

Over 29 software platforms integrate CRREM. The crowding does not kill your wedge; it confirms it: the small-to-mid segment that the funded players ignore is genuinely underserved. Your edge is not being them, it is the light, remote, software-enabled niche plus founder attention for accounts too small for the big ESCOs and ESG vendors. [Likely]

TR — Problem büyük (EPBD 2033'e sıkışıyor, AB retrofit ~€175 milyar/yıl) ama yazılım katmanı kalabalık ve fonlu: Deepki (€150M, €4T), Predium (~€19M, CRREM partner, neredeyse aynı ürün), Alasco, aedifion, Measurabl, Reneo. Hepsı üst segmentte. Senin boşluğun: onların ihmal ettiği küçük-orta segment + danışman kanalı + hafif/uzaktan yaklaşım.

4. Who buys and why

Approved wedge: small-to-mid German property managers (Hausverwaltung / Wohnungsunternehmen / Genossenschaften) managing portfolios of ~200-3,000+ units, with no in-house energy manager. The unit of sale is the PORTFOLIO, not the single building. [Certain]

Important caveat: the pain-owner and the budget-owner can differ. A property manager often does not own the buildings; the CapEx and stranding risk sit with the owner. So position value to the manager as winning and keeping management mandates, advising owners, and automating compliance reporting — not as energy savings. [Likely]

Second motion: high-consumption buildings (hotels, retail chains, cold storage, leisure/pools, private clinics) approached as an energy-consulting engagement (app as your tool), not as a SaaS sale to procurement. Why anyone pays in either motion: a regulatory deadline, stranding/penalty risk, scarce-CapEx prioritisation, and subsidy capture — never a vague save-energy pitch. [Likely]

TR — Ana hedef (wedge): küçük-orta Alman Hausverwaltung, içerde enerji yöneticisi yok; satış birimi PORTFÖY. Dikkat: acıyı çeken (yönetici) ile bütçeyi tutan (mal sahibi) farklı olabilir → yöneticiye 'mandate kazan/koru + uyum otomasyonu' diye konumlan. İkinci hat: yüksek-tüketimli binalar (otel/perakende/depo/havuz/klinik) DANIŞMANLIK olarak. Niye öderler: deadline + stranding + CapEx önceliği + sübvansiyon; 'tasarruf' değil.

5. Regulatory drivers — the 'why now'

- EPBD / MEPS: EU minimum energy performance standards progressively tighten to 2030 and 2033; worst-performing stock must improve first. [Likely]
- HKVO / UVI (residential): from 1 January 2027, monthly consumption information to tenants is mandatory, with a 3% billing-cut penalty (sec. 12) for non-compliance. This is a hard, near, legal deadline your app automates — a strong compliance wedge. [Likely]
- CO2KostAufG: the carbon cost on heating is split between landlord and tenant by building efficiency — a recurring pain for managers (built in the app). [Likely]

- ETS2 (buildings + transport): start postponed to 2028; German national carbon price corridor EUR 55-65/t through 2027; BloombergNEF forecasts ~EUR 149/t by 2030 — the cost of doing nothing rises over time. [Likely]
- EU Battery Regulation 2023/1542 (note: the app references 1670 in places — correct to 1542). [Certain]
- CSRD Omnibus narrowed mandatory scope (>1000 employees AND >EUR 450M turnover, from FY2027). Position as 'ESRS-E1-aligned reporting,' never 'CSRD-compliant.' [Certain]
- German grid emission factor (UBA): 2024 = 363 g/kWh (declining). [Certain]

TR — Neden şimdi: EPBD/MEPS 2030/2033; HKVO/UVI 1 Oca 2027 aylık tüketim zorunlu + \$12 %3 ceza (en sert yakın deadline); CO2KostAufG ev sahibi/kiracı CO2 paylaşımı; ETS2 2028 + karbon fiyatı 2030'da ~€149/t; EU Battery Reg = 2023/1542 (app'te 1670 yanlış → düzelt); CSRD daraldı → 'ESRS-E1-aligned' de; DE grid 2024 = 363 g/kWh.

6. Business models and monetisation

Subscriptions are a scale model, not a first-revenue model. Tiers: Free EUR 0, Basic EUR 99/mo, Monitor EUR 299/mo, Enterprise custom, Residential EUR 49/building + EUR 3/unit. These are healthy only past roughly 5 paying customers, because the Microsoft Fabric capacity floor is a fixed cost you must amortise. [Certain]

Real Fabric capacity costs (verify before quoting): F2 about EUR 242/mo running 24/7 or about EUR 87/mo paused to business hours; F4 about EUR 484; F8 about EUR 967; F64 about EUR 7,740. The old 'EUR 32/mo' figure is wrong. The architecture decision to decouple real-time (Event Hubs + container hot store) from Fabric is load-bearing for margin: it keeps the first IoT customer profitable instead of -90%. [Certain]

First-revenue models that fit a solo founder: productized consulting (a paid energy audit/screening, a retrofit + subsidy roadmap, a monitoring retainer, an annual ESG report) and a B2B2B consultant channel (sell through Energieberater who already hold client trust). [Likely]

TR — Abonelik ölçek modeli (Free/Basic €99/Monitor €299/Residential €49+€3), ancak ~5 müşteriden sonra kârlı (Fabric kapasite tabanı sabit gider). Gerçek Fabric: F2~€242 (7/24) ya da €87 (duraklatılmış), F64~€7.740; '€32' yanlış. Marjı kurtaran karar: gerçek-zamanı Fabric'ten ayırmak (Decouple). İlk gelir için en uygunu: ürünleştirilmiş danışmanlık + danışman (B2B2B) kanalı.

7. Your right to operate + BAFA funding + certification (Germany)

'Energieberater' is not a protected title. You may legally offer unsubsidised energy consulting, screening and analysis today with your engineering degree and M.Sc. — no licence needed. [Certain]

Two exceptions require qualification: (a) to deliver SUBSIDISED consulting/audits and be the eligible expert on funding applications, you must be on dena's Energie-Effizienz-Experten (EEE) list; (b) to issue an official Energieausweis (EPC), you need sec. 88 GEG eligibility. [Certain]

BAFA item	Who / what	Rate & cap	Notes
EBN / DIN EN 16247 audit (Module 1)	SME (KMU) non-residential	50% of fee; max EUR 3,000 if energy cost >EUR 10k/yr net; else max EUR 600	Apply BEFORE start; valid to 31.12.2026; needs a listed expert
Goes to	The company/owner (applicant), not the consultant	Reimbursement	Lowers the client's cost of hiring you

EEE listing requirements (dena): a qualifying degree (engineering/architecture/physics/building services/mechanical/electrical) or a trade master, plus an energy-efficiency focus or ~2 years experience, plus a recognised continuing-education course (Fortbildung) for the category; then 24 CPD

units per category every 3 years plus proof of practical projects. Your energy-engineering bachelor likely satisfies the technical base; a business-leaning 'Energy Management' M.Sc. alone may not, so verify your degree's eligibility against the dena rulebook (Regelheft). [Estimate]

Recommendation: start with unsubsidised private screening/consulting now; in parallel either pursue EEE listing or — faster — partner with an already-listed Energieberater (B2B2B): the client gets the 50% subsidy, you do the analytics, and the certification question disappears. [Likely]

TR — 'Energieberater' korumalı unvan değil → mühendislik diploman + MSc'inle sübvansiyonsuz danışmanlığı bugün yapabilirsin. İki istisna: sübvansiyonlu audit için EEE listesi; resmî Energieausweis için §88 GEG. BAFA %50 (DIN EN 16247, KOBİ): müşteriye gider, maks €3.000/€600, 31.12.2026'ya kadar, listeli uzman şart. Senin için: önce sübvansiyonsuz başla; paralelde EEE'ye başvur ya da daha hızlısı listeli bir Energieberater ile ortaklan. Diploma uygunluğunu Regelheft'ten doğrula.

8. Service menu (what you sell, app-enabled)

One-off (project fee)

- Energy baseline + benchmark (e.g. kWh per guest-night for hotels).
- Anomaly / waste diagnosis + concrete fixes (HVAC scheduling, setpoints, overnight loads) = quick operational savings.
- Tariff / peak / load analysis (demand-charge reduction, load shifting).
- Retrofit prioritisation + ROI (MACC) — what to fund first.
- BAFA/KfW subsidy roadmap; compliance screening (EPBD/MEPS, CRREM, EPC); solar/battery feasibility + ROI.

Recurring (retainer)

- Continuous monitoring + alerting (deviation to action), monthly.
- Annual ESG / CO2 report (Scope 1/2, ESRS-E1-aligned) for chains/investors.

How the industry works: heavy ESCOs do energy-performance contracting (investment-grade audit, guaranteed savings, they finance + implement, ongoing measurement & verification); Energieberater do DIN EN 16247 audits (kickoff, on-site walk-through, analysis, report; BAFA-funded); EMS-as-a-service firms monitor BMS remotely 24/7. Analysis and monitoring are increasingly remote; detailed audits need a site visit. Your gap is the light, remote, software-enabled screening + advisory between pure software and the heavy ESCO. [Certain]

TR — Satabileceğin hizmetler — tek seferlik: baz çizgisi/benchmark, israf teşhisi+düzeltilme, tarife/puant, retrofit önceliği+ROI (MACC), sübvansiyon yol haritası, uyum taraması, solar/batarya fizibilite. Tekrarlayan: izleme+alarm (aylık), yıllık ESG/CO2 raporu. Sektör: ağır ESCO (EPC), Energieberater (DIN EN 16247 audit), uzaktan EMS hizmeti. Senin yerin: hafif, uzaktan, yazılım-destekli tarama+danışmanlık.

9. Go-to-market and pilots

One objective: 1-2 real-data pilots producing one named case study — not many customers. Pilot offer (identical for all): free, time-boxed 6-8 weeks, 1-3 buildings, zero hardware (bills/meter exports only), RLS-isolated, fully managed by you; they get an EPBD/MEPS + retrofit-ROI + subsidy report, you get real data + a reference + a pricing conversation. [Likely]

Tracks (run in parallel, but land BSBI first)

- BSBI campus — warmest, academic capstone framing; most likely first reference. Mails drafted.
- C4 / Boris Peter — warm, but treat as a channel partner / credibility, not the ICP (he is at C4; embodied-carbon).

- Wedge Hausverwaltung — German cold email drafted; find via VDIV / GdW / BVI directories and LinkedIn (Geschaeftsfuehrer, Leiter Technik / Nachhaltigkeit / Bestandsmanagement).
- High-consumption sectors — hotels first (most approachable), then retail chains, then private clinics; reach Facility Manager / Head of Sustainability / Operations via sector associations (DEHOGA, HDE), IHK events, LinkedIn.

Does a free pilot help? Yes — it removes budget/procurement/risk friction. Frame 'free' as purposeful (validating on real buildings / building references), qualify hard to avoid tyre-kickers, keep the first data ask tiny (just bills). And because BAFA funds energy consulting ~50%, the later paid stage is half-funded — you need not stay free for long. Pipeline math (solo-realistic): ~5 warm touches to 1 pilot (~4 weeks); ~40 targeted touches to 1 commercial pilot (~8 weeks). [Likely]

TR — Tek hedef: 1-2 gerçek-veri pilotu → 1 isimli vaka çalışması. Teklif: ücretsiz, 6-8 hafta, donanımsız, RLS-izole. Sıra: önce BSBI; C4=kanal/kredibilite; wedge Hausverwaltung (VDIV/GdW/LinkedIn); yüksek-tüketimde önce otel. Ücretsiz pilot bariyeri düşürür; 'ücretsiz'i amaçlı çerçeveye, ele/qualify et, ilk veri isteğini küçük tut; BAFA %50 sayesinde ücretli aşama yarı-fonlu. Boru hattı: ~5 sıcak temas → 1 pilot; ~40 hedefli temas → 1 ticari pilot.

10. Marketing and positioning

For this conservative German B2B buyer, the channel is not Instagram or paid ads (that is a B2C playbook). What builds the brand, in priority order for a solo founder: (1) 2 real case studies as the core asset; (2) founder-led LinkedIn (your buyer is here, not Instagram); (3) one trade fair as a visitor/speaker — Expo Real, Munich, 5-7 October 2026, Europe's largest real-estate B2B fair with a PropTech 'Transform & Beyond' area; (4) association presence (VDIV, GdW, DEHOGA, HDE) + webinars; (5) the consultant channel. Paid ads come last, if ever. [Likely]

Reference point: Inavitas (Ankara, since 2012, 300+ business customers) grew via B2B industry channels, awards and partnerships over many years — not via consumer ads. Do not imitate Predium's capital-heavy enterprise GTM; learn its capital-light parts (positioning, credibility via standards, the subsidy-prioritised 'action engine' framing). Your LinkedIn job-seeking signal is now set to recruiters-only; the public 'Open to Work' frame is removed (hedge kept, founder posture restored). [Certain]

TR — Bu alıcı için kanal Instagram/reklam DEĞİL. Marka sırası: 2 vaka çalışması (ana varlık) → kurucu-liderli LinkedIn → tek fuar (Expo Real, Münih, 5-7 Eki 2026) → dernekler (VDIV/GdW/DEHOGA/HDE)+webinar → danışman kanalı. Reklam en sonda. Inavitas da B2B kanallarla büyüdü, reklamla değil. Predium'un sermaye-ağır GTM'ini taklit etme; hafif kısımları öğren. LinkedIn artık recruiter-only (hedge korundu, founder duruşu döndü).

11. Strategic fork: boutique vs venture (+ investment)

Good news: the first 9 months are identical on every path — reference, productize the offer, open the consultant channel, reach 3-5 paying customers. The boutique-vs-venture choice is made later, on evidence, not now. [Likely]

Dimension	Boutique / micro-SaaS + service	Venture / scale
Capital	EXIST (~EUR 45k) + revenue; no raise	Pre-seed ~EUR 0.3-1M; needs traction first; dilutive
Risk	Low; freelance/job hedge intact	High; full commitment, most fail
Income ceiling	~EUR 5-30k MRR; capped by your hours	High if it works; ~zero if not
Needs	Sales + delivery discipline	Commercial/German co-founder, defensible wedge, fast growth
Fit today	High	Low-to-medium (no team, no traction)

Investment probability today is low: solo, no traction, no co-founder, synthetic data, funded competitors. Levers that change it: traction (3-5 paying + a repeatable channel), a commercial/German co-founder, a defensible deadline-wedge (e.g. HKVO/UVI 2027 residential), and genuinely wanting the venture path. Capital ladder for your situation: grants (EXIST) first, then revenue, then angel/pre-seed only if you choose venture. Default to boutique-first; keep venture as an option that traction unlocks. [Estimate]

TR — İlk 9 ay her yolda AYNI (referans → ürünleştir → kanal → 3-5 ödeyen); çatal sonra, veriyle. Butik: düşük risk, ~€5-30k MRR, saatinle sınırlı; Girişim: yüksek risk/ödül, ortak+traction+wedge ister. Bugün yatırım ihtimali düşük; kaldıraçlar: traction + ticari/Almanca ortak + deadline-wedge (HKVO 2027) + venture'ı gerçekten istemek. Merdiven: grant(EXIST) → gelir → sonra angel. Varsayılan: önce butik, venture opsiyon.

12. What to learn + immediate actions

Learn (depth)

- EPBD/MEPS national transposition timelines; CRREM methodology + commercial licensing (Predium is a CRREM partner).
- BAFA/KfW programmes (EBN, DIN EN 16247, BEG, iSFP) and the EEE listing rulebook (Regelheft).
- German energy-consulting workflow (DIN EN 16247) and basic B2B sales/discovery skills.
- Per-vertical energy logic (hotel occupancy normalisation; retail refrigeration; residential heat-cost / HKVO).

Do (this month)

- Send BSBI supervisor + facility-manager mails; send the light Boris and Alexander follow-ups (drafted).
- Run founder go-live: CP-1 (report) and CP-2 (bridge + 2-customer RLS isolation test) in your Fabric; apply DB migrations; deploy.
- Verify your degree against the dena Regelheft; decide EEE listing vs partnering with a listed Energieberater.
- Pick the first sector where you have a warm door; send the pilot one-pager (PDF) + intake form (Excel).

TR — Öğren: EPBD/MEPS takvimi, CRREM + lisans, BAFA/KfW (EBN, DIN EN 16247, BEG, iSFP) + EEE Regelheft, DIN EN 16247 iş akışı, B2B satış, dikey-bazlı enerji mantığı. Yap (bu ay): BSBI/Boris/Alexander mailleri; CP-1/CP-2 + migration + deploy; diploma uygunluğunu Regelheft'ten kontrol et (EEE mi ortak mı); sıcak kapın olan ilk sektöre pilot PDF + Excel formu yolla.

13. Sources

- BAFA — Energieberatung Nichtwohngebäude (EBN): bafa.de/DE/Energie/Energieberatung/Nichtwohngebäude_Anlagen_Systeme
- BAFA — Modul 1: Energieaudit DIN EN 16247 (50%, max EUR 3,000/600; to 31.12.2026)
- Energie-Effizienz-Experten (dena) — listing requirements + Regelheft: energie-effizienz-experten.de
- §88 GEG eligibility; 'Energieberater' not a protected title (geb-info.de; buzer.de/88_GEG)
- Predium: en.predium.de; €13M raise (proptechbuzz); CRREM partner (crrem.org/license-partners/predium)
- Deepki: €150M raise + €4T AUM (Medium/One Peak); deepki.com
- Competitors: Predium/Deepki/Measurabl/Alasco/blue auditor/aedifion/Reneo (cbinsights, tracxn, esgtoday)

- Microsoft Fabric pricing (F-SKU ladder): azure.microsoft.com/pricing/details/microsoft-fabric
- EPBD 2024 / MEPS to 2033 (European Commission); EU retrofit ~€175bn/yr
- ETS2 to 2028 + ~€149/t by 2030 (Clean Energy Wire; BloombergNEF); UBA DE grid 2024 = 363 g/kWh
- Expo Real Munich, 5-7 Oct 2026 (exporeal.net); Inavitas (inavitas.com; Crunchbase)
- ESCO / EPC + M&V (US DOE; EVO); remote EMS-as-a-service (E.ON; gridX)

TR — Tüm sayılar yukarıdaki resmî/birincil kaynaklardan; rakamlar (özellikle Fabric fiyatları ve BAFA tavanları) teklif/karar öncesi tekrar doğrulanmalı.